

Study On Social Perception of Hindi Dialects

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Abstract

This study aims to understand the perception of different dialects of Hindi, namely Standard Hindi, Persianized Hindi, Bhojpuri using Matched guise technique and Bogardus Social distance Scale.

1 Introduction

This study investigates the social perceptions of various Hindi dialects using a matched-guise test and the Bogardus Social Distance Scale. Participants were exposed to audio samples of different Hindi dialects, followed by a questionnaire designed to capture their attitudes and biases. The study specifically focuses on Bhojpuri and Persianized Hindi, chosen due to a hypothesis that these dialects are often stigmatized and elicit strong opinions. Through comprehensive data analysis, both overall and within subsets defined by region and age, the study examines the validity of this hypothesis, shedding light on linguistic attitudes and social stereotypes. The findings aim to enhance understanding of how dialectal variation influences social perception and the role of demographic factors in shaping these attitudes.

1.1 Matched guise Scale

The matched-guise test is a sociolinguistic method for studying language attitudes. Participants hear audio recordings of the same speaker using different linguistic varieties, unaware that the speaker is identical across samples. This isolates judgments based on language rather than personal traits. Participants rate the guises on attributes like education, friendliness, or trustworthiness, revealing implicit biases and stereotypes tied to specific linguistic forms and societal perceptions.

1.2 Bogardus Social Distance Scale

The Bogardus Social Distance Scale measures an individual's willingness to engage in varying levels of social relationships with different groups. Developed in 1925, it ranks relationships from intimate (e.g., in-laws) to impersonal (e.g., fellow citizens). Participants indicate their comfort level with each, revealing social distance or prejudice. In linguistic studies, it highlights how dialects or accents affect perceptions of acceptability and social integration, linking language to identity and societal attitudes.

1.3 Data Collection

The study utilizes matched-guise test and Bogardus Social distance Scale to examine linguistic and social perceptions of Persianized Hindi and Bhojpuri. A neutral text was translated into the dialects with native speaker input to ensure accuracy, and audio recordings were made by multiple speakers, selecting the most natural version. Native speakers reviewed tone, pronunciation, and inflection for authenticity.

A questionnaire was developed to assess perceptions and initially distributed online, yielding a low response rate. To improve participation, individuals were approached directly and assisted with the form. This mixed-methods approach enabled a thorough analysis of the relationship between linguistic features and social attitudes. The audios, their transcriptions, questionnaire and collected data are attached in the Appendix.

2 Literature Review

Research on the social perception of Hindi dialects is sparse, with most existing literature focusing on comparisons between Hindi and Urdu. The following works were instrumental in shaping the research methodology and hypotheses for this study:

1. **Gaies, Stephen J., & Beebe, Jacqueline D.:** *The Matched-Guise Technique for Measuring Attitudes and Their Implications for Language Education: A Critical Assessment.*
[Link](#)

- This study offered key insights into the proper application of the matched-guise technique, ensuring unbiased guises and refining this study's methodology.

2. **Wark, Colin & Galliher, John F. Emory Bogardus and the Origins of the Social Distance Scale.**
[Link](#)

- This article highlighted the relevance of the Bogardus Social Distance Scale, influencing the decision to incorporate it alongside the matched-guise test for a more holistic analysis.

3. **Mesthrie, Rajend:** *Language in Indenture: A Sociolinguistic History of Bhojpuri-Hindi in South Africa.*
[Link](#)

- Though focused on Bhojpuri speakers in South Africa, this work provided valuable context for formulating hypotheses related to Bhojpuri perceptions.

4. **Rahman, Motiur & Gautam, Arvind Kumar:** *Language Attitude of Hindi-Urdu Speakers in Patiali: A Perspective.*
[Link](#)

- This article contributed to hypotheses development for Persianized Hindi by providing context for its linguistic and cultural associations.

3 Problem Statement

Understanding linguistic and social perceptions of dialects is critical in uncovering societal attitudes,

biases, and stereotypes. This study focuses on analyzing participant perceptions of Bhojpuri and Persianized Hindi, dialects often associated with stigma or strong opinions. Using a mixed-methods approach, the research investigates:

1. Central Tendencies and Variability:

What statistical patterns emerge from participants' ratings of these dialects across various linguistic and social attributes?

2. Nuanced Insights and Biases:

How do qualitative trends and participant commentary reveal underlying stereotypes, cultural influences, or prejudices?

3. Demographic Influences:

- How do perceptions vary by age, region, and exposure to different linguistic environments? Specifically:
- What general trends are observed across the entire dataset?
- How do age-related and regional factors influence perceptions, particularly among the older population in Rajasthan?
- What regional differences exist in the attitudes of younger participants (19–28 years) across Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, and Uttar Pradesh (Explored briefly)?

By integrating statistical and contextual analyses, the study aims to provide a comprehensive understanding of how linguistic variation shapes social attitudes and to identify the demographic and cultural factors that influence these perceptions.

4 Analysis

4.1 Analysis of Overall Data

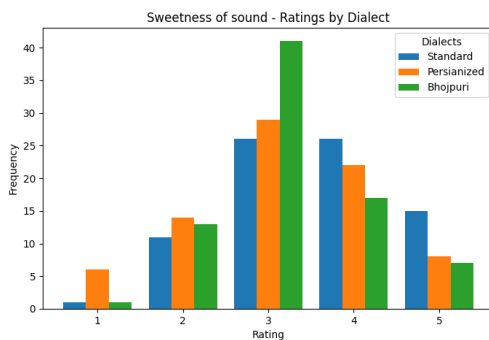
- Form entries: 79
- Demographics:
 - Most reported to encounter Hindi often in their lives.
 - Most had at least undergraduate level of education
 - Responses mostly from Northern India: UP, MP, Rajasthan, Delhi.
 - 74.7% Male rest Female

- Quantitative analysis: Find the overall quantitative analysis in the file Quantitative.xlsx attached in Appendix. In this report we focus on the qualitative analysis of data and hypotheses drawn from the observed distribution of data.

4.1.1 Qualitative Analysis

In the below sections, we examine the graphical representations of participant responses to each question across the three key categories: Linguistic Perception, Social Perception, and Social Distance. By analyzing the trends and patterns in the data visualizations, we derive insights into the participants' attitudes and biases toward the target dialects

4.1.2 Sweetness

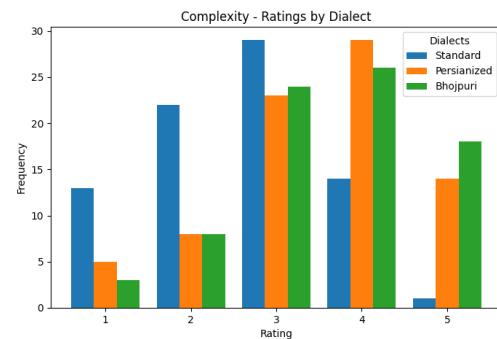


- Standard Hindi Perceived as the Sweetest:** Standard Hindi received the highest sweetness ratings, particularly with a concentration at rating 4, surpassing the expectation that Persianized Hindi would rank highest due to its poetic associations. This result likely stems from **familiarity bias**—participants' extensive exposure to Standard Hindi in education, media, and formal contexts may make it more pleasant or neutral in perception.
- Bhojpuri Rated Moderately Sweet:** Bhojpuri exhibited a clustering around rating 3, indicating perceptions of moderate sweetness. This may arise from its melodic intonation and ties to rural life, folk music, and cultural traditions, which impart charm despite stigmas. Additionally, many participants may lack familiarity with Bhojpuri, leading to neutral ratings (3).

- Polarized Opinions on Persianized Hindi** Persianized Hindi showed polarized ratings, with significant responses at the extremes (1 and 2) as well as moderate ratings. This suggests **divided perceptions**, potentially due to:

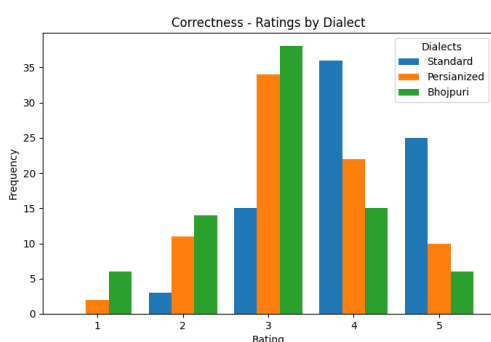
- Familiarity issues:** Many participants may find it "foreign sounding," leading to lower ratings.
- Religious prejudice:** As Persianized Hindi is associated with Muslim communities, Hindu participants—particularly older individuals—may have rated it unfavorably due to cultural or religious biases.

4.1.3 Complexity



- Hypothesis:** Bhojpuri would be perceived as a rudimentary and simpler language, potentially due to features like copula omission.
- Observation:** Contrary to expectations, Standard Hindi was rated as the "simplest" of the three varieties. This likely reflects participants' perception of simplicity as the ease of understanding the language.
- Bhojpuri:** Rated as the most complex, possibly due to its low mutual intelligibility with the participants' primary languages, as most were from Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, and other non-Bhojpuri-speaking regions.
- Persianized Hindi:** Rated higher in complexity, likely because it incorporates "sophisticated" or "complicated"-sounding words such as *taalim* and *mutmaen*.

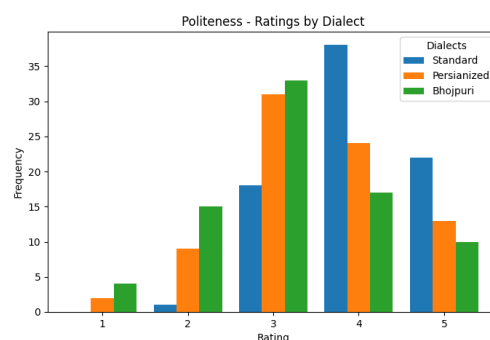
4.1.4 Correctness



- Standard Hindi Rated Highest for Correctness:** Standard Hindi received the highest frequency of ratings at 4, emphasizing its perception as the "most correct" dialect. This aligns with its status as the standardized and formalized version of Hindi, taught in schools and used in official communication. Participants likely associate Standard Hindi with grammatical accuracy and linguistic authority, reinforcing its perceived correctness.
- Bhojpuri Viewed as Moderately Correct:** Bhojpuri received predominantly middle ratings (3 and 4), indicating that while participants acknowledge it as a legitimate dialect, it is not widely regarded as "correct" in the formal or standard sense. This perception might stem from Bhojpuri's association with informal settings, regional speech, and its lack of institutional support as compared to Standard Hindi.
- Polarized Opinions on Persianized Hindi:** Persianized Hindi shows considerable ratings at both ends of the spectrum, with some participants rating it as highly correct (4) and others assigning it lower scores (2). This polarization could reflect:
 - Perception of complexity:** Persianized Hindi's elevated vocabulary and historical association with elite discourse may appeal to some as "refined and correct."
 - Perception of deviation:** For others, it may seem less correct because it

diverges significantly from the standard and lacks widespread familiarity.

4.1.5 Politeness

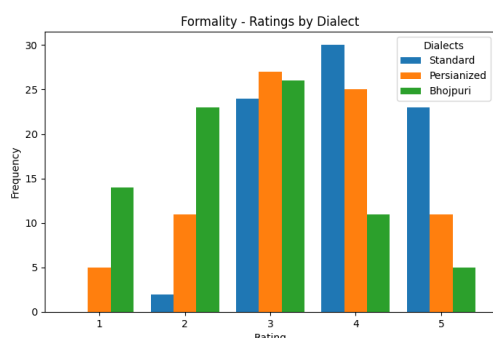


- Bhojpuri Perceived as Moderately Polite:** Contrary to the belief that Bhojpuri would be perceived as somewhat impolite due to its rural associations, Bhojpuri received the highest frequency of ratings at 3, indicating that participants generally don't really have any opinion on its politeness and were unsure or indifferent towards its politeness. While another subset rated it higher (4s, 5s) This result may stem from the fact that all the audios do seem to have an intonation which can be considered polite so rather than the dialect its the audio intonation being rated polite, since a the participants who rated Bhojpuri high on politeness also rated it high on complexity, indicating they relied more on the tonality of the audio.
- Standard Hindi Seen as Neutral to Polite:** Ratings for Standard Hindi were concentrated around 3 and 4, suggesting it is perceived as polite, albeit in a neutral or moderate sense. As the standardized form used in formal and professional settings, participants likely associate it with balanced, non-excessive politeness.
- Persianized Hindi's Polarized Politeness Ratings:** Persianized Hindi exhibited a wider spread of ratings, with notable frequencies at both low (2) and high (4) scores. This pattern reflects its nuanced perception:
 - For some, Persianized Hindi's elaborate vocabulary and

association with poetic traditions might evoke high levels of politeness.

- Others might perceive it as overly ornate or indirect, leading to lower ratings, particularly if they associate politeness with straightforwardness or simplicity.

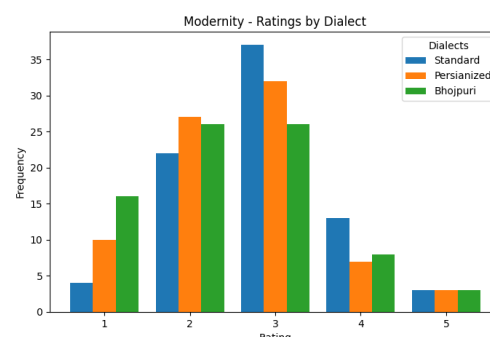
4.1.6 Formality



- Bhojpuri Perceived as Informal:** Bhojpuri received its highest ratings at 2 and 3, indicating that participants predominantly view it as informal. This perception likely stems from its association with rural contexts, oral traditions, and lack of representation in formal or institutional domains. Additionally, biases linking rural dialects to less formal settings may reinforce these attitudes.
- Standard Hindi Seen as Highly Formal:** Ratings for Standard Hindi peaked at 4 and 5, solidifying its perception as the most formal dialect. This can be attributed to its role as the standardized language used in education, governance, and official communication. The structured and codified nature of Standard Hindi further reinforces its association with high formality.
- Persianized Hindi Considered Moderately Formal:** Persianized Hindi had significant ratings at 3 and 4, suggesting it is perceived as moderately formal. This perception may arise from its historical association with poetic and elite traditions, which lends it an air of sophistication. However, its limited modern usage and potential unfamiliarity

among younger or less culturally inclined participants might moderate its formality ratings.

4.1.7 Modernity



- Standard Hindi Perceived as Less Modern:** Most ratings for Standard Hindi clustered around 3 (37 responses) and 2 (22 responses), suggesting it is viewed as moderately outdated. This perception might arise from its lack of code-switching and rigid adherence to formal structures, making it feel less dynamic and adaptable in contemporary, multilingual contexts.
- Persianized Hindi Viewed as Historically Rooted:** Persianized Hindi also saw a concentration of ratings around 3 (32 responses) and 2 (27 responses), reflecting perceptions of limited modernity. This is likely linked to its association with historical and cultural contexts, as highlighted by terms like *_begum_* (noted by one respondent) that evoke imagery of a bygone era rather than present-day usage.
- Bhojpuri Seen as Traditional or Rural:** Bhojpuri received a significant number of low modernity ratings (1 and 2, with 16 and 26 responses, respectively). This is probably influenced by stereotypes tied to socio-economic disparities and its frequent portrayal in media as a rural or rustic dialect. Such associations may reinforce perceptions of it being less aligned with modern, urbanized contexts.

4.1.8 Trustworthiness and Friendliness

417	• Standard Hindi Perceived as Most	463	backgrounds, which may undermine
418	Friendly and Trustworthy: Standard	464	perceptions of reliability or competence
419	Hindi received high ratings for both	465	despite its warmth.
420	friendliness (4: 40 responses; 5: 11	466	
421	responses) and trustworthiness (4: 42	467	4.1.9 Education Level and Economic
422	responses; 5: 15 responses). Its	468	Status
423	association with formal, official	469	• Standard Hindi Perceived as
424	communication and education likely	470	Economically Stable and Educated:
425	fosters perceptions of reliability and	471	Standard Hindi consistently received
426	warmth. Additionally, its neutral tone	472	high ratings for both economic status (3:
427	and widespread familiarity might	473	37 responses; 4: 33 responses) and
428	enhance its approachability, positioning	474	education level (4: 36 responses; 5: 15
429	it as both friendly and dependable.	475	responses). This reflects its association
430		476	with formal, institutional domains
431	• Persianized Hindi Moderately Friendly	477	where both economic and educational
432	but Lower on Trustworthiness:	478	markers are strong. Its widespread use
433	Persianized Hindi showed moderate	479	in urban, professional, and academic
434	friendliness (3: 41 responses; 4: 15	480	contexts positions it as a dialect tied to
435	responses) but had a more polarized	481	higher economic status and education.
436	distribution for trustworthiness, with	482	As the standardized form of Hindi, it is
437	notable frequencies in the lower ratings	483	perceived as a language of stability and
438	(1: 6 responses; 2: 17 responses). While	484	higher learning, reinforcing its
439	its cultural and historical associations	485	reputation as the most educated and
440	may evoke some level of sophistication,	486	economically balanced dialect.
441	the lower trustworthiness ratings could	487	
442	reflect social biases, particularly	488	• Persianized Hindi Associated with
443	religious prejudices tied to its historical	489	Moderate Economic and Educational
444	connection with Persianate culture and	490	Status: Persianized Hindi received
445	Islamic traditions. The use of terms like	491	moderate ratings for both economic
446	<i>begum</i> and <i>taalim</i> , as previously noted,	492	status (3: 47 responses) and education
447	might unintentionally reinforce	493	level (3: 43 responses), suggesting that it
448	perceptions of cultural or religious	494	is seen as a dialect tied to sophistication
449	"otherness" among participants with	495	but not necessarily mainstream
450	preconceived biases.	496	economic or educational success. Its
451		497	historical associations with elite
452	• Bhojpuri Perceived as Friendly but Less	498	Persianate culture might contribute to
453	Trustworthy: Bhojpuri scored well for	499	perceptions of exclusivity or cultural
454	friendliness (3: 42 responses; 4 and 5: 12	500	refinement. However, the lower ratings
455	responses each), indicating it is seen as	501	for both categories (1 and 2 for both
456	approachable and warm. However,	502	education and economic status) indicate
457	trustworthiness ratings were lower, with	503	that some participants might view it as
458	the majority at 3 (34 responses) and a	504	less relevant to contemporary education
459	significant proportion at 2 (25	505	systems or mainstream economic
460	responses). This disparity could stem	506	success.
461	from stereotypes associating Bhojpuri	507	
462	speakers with informality or rural		

- **Bhojpuri Perceived as Lower in Both Economic Status and Education:** Bhojpuri's ratings for economic status (2: 25 responses; 3: 37 responses) and education level (2: 25 responses; 3: 33 responses) show a clear association with lower economic and educational levels. Its dominant use in rural and informal contexts, along with its lack of representation in formal education or high-prestige media, positions it as a dialect linked to lower socio-economic groups and limited access to educational resources. This reflects societal biases that often equate rural dialects like Bhojpuri with lower social standing and educational attainment.

4.1.10 Social Distance

This study explores perceptions of social distance toward speakers of Standard Hindi, Persianized Hindi, and Bhojpuri, assessed through categories like close family members, friends, neighbors, coworkers, and fellow citizens.

1. Standard Hindi: Least Socially Distant

- **Close Relationships:** Standard Hindi is highly rated for close family (4: 42 responses) and friends (4: 47, 5: 13 responses). It is perceived as neutral, formal, and appropriate for personal interactions.
- **Community and Workplace:** It excels in professional contexts (5: 46 responses for coworkers) and neighborly relations (4, 5: 35 each), reflecting its role as a widely accepted medium of communication.
- **National Identity:** With 5 (61 responses) for fellow citizens, Standard Hindi is the least socially distant, symbolizing unity and formal inclusivity.
- **Conclusion:** Its widespread use and neutrality make it highly versatile and socially acceptable across all categories.

2. Persianized Hindi: Moderate Social Distance

- **Close Relationships:** Ratings are polarized for family (3: 27, 2: 24) and friends (3: 23, 4: 21), indicating formal or distant perceptions.
- **Community and Workplace:** It is moderately accepted as a neighbor (3: 35, 4: 24) and coworker (4: 32), seen as formal but less natural for casual settings.
- **National Identity:** Ratings for fellow citizens are less cohesive (4: 34, 5: 31), highlighting its limited accessibility and association with cultural and religious identities.
- **Conclusion:** Persianized Hindi's complexity and ties to historical and religious contexts may hinder its acceptance in personal or casual interactions.

3. Bhojpuri: Mixed Perceptions

- **Close Relationships:** Moderate ratings dominate for family (3: 35, 2: 20) and friends (3: 32, 4: 18), reflecting its informality and emotional appeal.
- **Community and Workplace:** It performs well with neighbors (4: 40), indicating comfort in local interactions, but lower for coworkers (3: 12, 4: 43) due to perceived informality.
- **National Identity:** High ratings (5: 42) for fellow citizens affirm its cultural relevance, though primarily within regional contexts.
- **Conclusion:** Bhojpuri's informal and regional nature fosters familiarity but limits its professional and formal acceptability.

4.2 Age Based Analysis

See the graphs for different age groups attached in Appendix.

- Deviations observed in older population (region: Rajasthan)
- Entries classified as Young (15-28): 58
- Entries classified as Old (32- 80): 21
- The Older generation data is primarily from Rajasthan.

- This analysis focuses primarily on the older generation, the analysis for younger generation remains largely the same as the overall analysis, except that the older generation seems to have rated Persianized Hindi quite negatively, thus the younger generation has a more positive perception of Perception of Persianized Hindi than the data indicates. However, the relative values remain largely the same.

4.2.1 Linguistic Perception

- **Complexity Perception:** The older generation rates all three dialects—Standard Hindi, Persianized Hindi, and Bhojpuri—as more complex compared to the younger generation. This may stem from the older cohort's linguistic background in Rajasthan, where Marwari is the primary language. Limited exposure to Standard Hindi in daily life likely contributes to their perception of Hindi dialects as intricate or less accessible.
- **Sweetness of Persianized Hindi:** The older generation's ratings for the sweetness of Persianized Hindi are evenly distributed, reflecting a mix of admiration and aversion. This duality could be attributed to two key factors:
 - Its association with elite, poetic, and literary traditions, which might evoke positive sentiments.
 - Potential stigma rooted in religious or cultural prejudices, where the Persianized elements may be viewed as foreign or non-native.
- **Politeness of Bhojpuri:** The older generation assigns higher politeness scores to Bhojpuri, possibly due to their lack of exposure to media stereotypes that often portray Bhojpuri speakers in derogatory or comedic roles. This contrasts with the younger generation, whose perceptions may be influenced by these stereotypes.

- **Formality of Standard Hindi:** The younger generation views Standard Hindi as significantly more formal than other dialects, a deviation from the older generation's more uniform perception of formality across dialects. This could be linked to the younger cohort's active participation in educational institutions and professional environments, where Standard Hindi serves as the medium of formal communication.

4.2.2 Social Perceptions

- **Modernity:** Younger participants perceive all three dialects—Standard, Persianized Hindi, and Bhojpuri—as less modern, likely due to their exposure to code-switching with English, absent in the study's data. Older participants view Standard Hindi as neutral in modernity, with Persianized Hindi and Bhojpuri seen as old-fashioned due to their historical and rural associations.
- **Education:** Older participants associate Standard Hindi with higher education, reflecting its historical use in formal instruction. Persianized Hindi's literary roots and Bhojpuri's rural background contribute to perceptions of lower educational alignment, particularly among older generations.
- **Friendliness:** Bhojpuri is rated as friendlier by older participants, linked to its rural, community-based origins, while Standard Hindi feels more formal and institutional, creating emotional distance.
- **Prejudice:** Persianized Hindi receives lower friendliness ratings from older participants, reflecting biases tied to cultural stigmas, historical tensions, or its perceived elite and foreign connections.
- **Trustworthiness:** Standard Hindi is seen as the most trustworthy by both age groups, due to its role in education,

media, and governance, reinforcing its neutrality and reliability.

4.2.3 Social Distance

- **Preference for Standard Hindi:** Older participants consistently favor Standard Hindi across all relationships, valuing its neutrality and association with education, professionalism, and national identity. Its perceived trustworthiness makes it the preferred dialect for family, friends, coworkers, and neighbors.
- **Religious Bias Against Persianized Hindi:** Persianized Hindi receives lower ratings for close relationships, such as family and friends, due to its association with Muslims. Historical communal tensions amplify these biases, reflecting significant cultural barriers in social distance scores.
- **Linguistic Divide with Bhojpuri:** Older participants rate Bhojpuri lower for close relationships, possibly due to mutual unintelligibility with their native Marwari. This reinforces a sense of “otherness,” contributing to social distance, though it is pragmatically accepted for coworkers and fellow citizens.
- **Bhojpuri’s Rural Identity:** Bhojpuri’s moderate ratings for workplace and neighbor interactions highlight its relatability and grounded nature. However, its rural connotations limit its suitability for personal or professional relationships, particularly among older generations.
- **Greater Social Distance for Non-Standard Dialects:** Both Bhojpuri and Persianized Hindi face higher social distance than Standard Hindi, especially among older participants. This reflects generational differences in linguistic exposure, adaptability, and cultural openness.

4.3 Regional Analysis

Analysis performed on 3 subsets of data by regions, Rajasthan, MP and UP (age 19 -2) and the following are some of the observations which deviate from the general trend (Graphs attached in appendix):

4.3.1 Madhya Pradesh

- 9 Form entries
- Persianized Hindi was rated more sweet sounding, proper, polite on average likely due to the popularity of poetry and Shaayari. (Influence of media on dialect perception)
- Regardless of the above positive influence, there was no positive correlation in the social distance scale. This indicates that while they may have positive perceptions about the dialect it does not influence social closeness.
- Bhojpuri was evaluated more negatively than average. I infer this is also an influence of media as stereotypical representation of Bhojpuri speakers is common in dramas and interned skits popular in this region. Standard Hindi had very high positive scores. This may be due to the high popularity of the dialect as it is spoken by the majority of the population in the region.

4.3.2 Rajasthan

- 18 Form entries
- All dialects showed lower scores than average. This may be due to less exposure of Hindi as the language typically spoken here is Marwari.
- Persianized Hindi is observed to be give much lower scores. This may be due to the fact that Rajasthan is predominantly Hindu dominated (88.49%) and the population of orthodox Hindus is more, leading to a more negative evaluation of Persianized Hindi due to religious prejudices.
- Persianized Hindi's rating leaned towards harsh sounding, compared to sweet sounding in case of MP and UP. This indicates how social background and exposure to media can impact one's perceptions, and there are no universal perceptions of dialects.

- Overall social distance score were low indicating that the respondents were relatively uncomfortable forming close relationships with the speakers of all 3 dialects, probably due to preferring people speaking the same dialect, Marwari. Standard Hindi still showed better scores.

4.3.3 Uttar Pradesh

- 12 form entries
- Both dialects showed higher scores than average .
- Persianized Hindi had higher linguistic perception scores than average in this region due to more familiarity.
- Just like MP, here too Persianized Hindi had high sweetness scores due to the popularity of Shaayari and poetry.
- Persianized Hindi was rated largely neutral on the social perception scale, meaning people did not draw any social evaluations based on this dialect. This may be because people from various backgrounds reside in UP who speak this dialect making judgement difficult.
- Bhojpuri and Persianized Hindi were both rated as less complex, possibly due to the prevalence of these dialects in this region so people don't find them too complicated.
- Bhojpuri also had higher scores in language perception than average as it is less foreign here however it still scored low on the social perception scale. Possibly due to the tensions rising due to migration of people from Bihar and Bihari residents being of lower socioeconomic background which led to these judgements.

5 Final Conclusions

- Standard Hindi is the most positively rated variety, even in subsets.
- People evaluated Bhojpuri negatively due to association with low socioeconomic background and stereotypical media portal.
- The views of Persianized Hindi were negatively influenced by religious prejudices and positively influenced by its cultural and literary associations.

- People hold different perceptions of dialects across regions.
- Evaluating a dialect positively may not always translate to greater social acceptance.
- Younger generation is more socially accepting than older generation.
- Mutual intelligibility plays a crucial role in the linguistic perception of dialect.
- Social perception of dialects is largely influenced by non linguistic factors.

Limitations

- The data set was fairly small 79 to draw any solid conclusions.
- Our analysis of older generation was restricted to the Rajasthan region thus it may not reflect the overall opinion of the older generation.
- Our regional analysis was restricted to particular cities rather than multiple cities across the region thus it was more granular and overall conclusion for the region can't be drawn.
- The respondents were mostly Hindu, which may have affected the ratings for Persianized Hindi.
- There were not many inferences which could be drawn as mostly a few factors (listed in conclusion) were responsible for most of the biases in perception of the dialect.

Ethics Statement

This study adheres to ethical guidelines in research involving human participants.

- Informed Consent: Participants were informed of the study's objectives, methods, and their right to withdraw at any

time. Consent was obtained before participation.

- Confidentiality: Participant data was anonymized and stored securely to ensure privacy.

- Voluntary Participation: Participation was voluntary, with no coercion or incentives provided.

- Respect for Participants: The study respected participants' linguistic and cultural diversity, aiming to avoid reinforcing stereotypes.

- Sensitivity: The research was conducted with care to avoid harm and presented responsibly, given the sensitive nature of language, religion, and ethnicity.

References

The Matched-Guise Technique for Measuring Attitudes and Their Implications for Language Education: A Critical Assessment. Gaies, Stephen J.; Beebe, Jacqueline D.

Emory Bogardus and the Origins of the Social Distance Scale. Colin Wark & John F. Galliher

Language in Indenture A Sociolinguistic History of Bhojpuri-Hindi in South Africa By Rajend Mesthrie

Language Attitude of Hindi-Urdu Speakers in Patiali A Perspective.- Rahman, Motiur, Gautam, Arvind Kumar

Appendices

- Standard Hindi audio
- Persianized Hindi audio
- Bhojpuri audio
- Transcribed Audios
- Questionnaire
- Collected Data
- Overall quantitative analysis
- Overall Analysis Graphs
- Age variation Graphs
- Regional Variation Graphs